



FREE GUIDE · FOR CLINICAL TRIAL SITES & SPONSORS

The Clinical Trial Site's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Investigational product destruction with an
auditable chain of custody — plus every stream.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Documentation is the deliverable.

Clinical trial sites and sponsors must document the destruction of unused and returned investigational product — including controlled substances — with an auditable chain of custody that satisfies sponsors, monitors, and the FDA. Add study sharps and biohazard, and you need a partner who gets the paperwork right. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered partner can destroy investigational product and controls with the chain-of-custody documentation your monitors and sponsors expect — plus sharps and biohazard. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Investigational product destruction

Unused, returned, and expired investigational product — the stream your monitors audit.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unused & returned IP
- Expired investigational lots
- Non-controlled study drug

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled IP (own path)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Destroyed with documented chain of custody and Certificates of Destruction to satisfy sponsor, monitor, and FDA requirements.

DISPOSE WITH · Documented destruction with chain-of-custody records.

Tip

Reconcile returned IP before destruction — the audit trail must tie accountability to disposal.

WASTE STREAM 02

Controlled substances

Investigational or ancillary controlled substances.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused controlled IP
- Wasted quantities
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled destruction to DEA standards, with documentation.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 03

Sharps

Study-related injection and blood-draw sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection & infusion needles
- Blood-draw sharps
- Lancets & syringes

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Study specimen and procedure biohazard.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood & specimen biohazard
- Contaminated study materials
- Contaminated PPE

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The clinical trial compliance checklist.

- ☐ Investigational product reconciled, then destroyed with documented chain of custody.
- ☐ Controlled IP rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Study sharps in FDA-cleared containers.

- ☐ Specimen and procedure biohazard handled per state rules.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction tied to accountability records for monitors and the FDA.
- ☐ Documentation retained per protocol and sponsor requirements.

QUESTIONS RESEARCH SITES ASK

Your clinical trial questions, answered.

What documentation do sponsors and monitors expect for IP destruction?

A chain-of-custody record that ties returned/unused product accountability to its destruction, plus a Certificate of Destruction — audit-ready for monitoring visits and the FDA.

Can you handle controlled investigational product?

Yes — controlled IP is rendered non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41, consistent with your registration.

Do you serve both sites and sponsors?

Yes — site-level service or sponsor-coordinated programs across multiple sites.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle destroys investigational product and controls with the chain-of-custody documentation monitors and sponsors require — plus study sharps and biohazard — with Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Investigational product	Documented destruction (chain of custody)
Controlled IP	Controlled destruction (Form 41)
Study sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Specimen biohazard	Biohazard kit or pickup



Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Multi-site studies often need sponsor-coordinated pickup and unified reporting — we'll build it. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY CLINICAL TRIAL SITES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your clinical trial site waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop